



Norstar Junior Inline Hockey Club

Dear Parent/Carer

We are pleased to welcome you and your child to **Norstar Junior Inline Hockey Club**.

The club is open to boys and girls aged 5-14, both experienced players and those new to inline hockey. We have spaces for both goalies and players.

We train on Saturday afternoons from 1.30pm - 4.30pm in Ballymena North Business and Recreation Centre, 120 Cushendall Road, Ballymena, BT43 6HB.

LTP Players should arrive by 1.15pm and be ready to enter the hall at 1.25pm. The Learn to Play Session runs from 1.30pm until 3pm.

The Academy runs for more experienced players from 3pm until 4.30pm.

Our Head Coach is Scott, a Level 3 USA Ice Hockey Certified Coach and Head Coach with Team Ireland and Titans Development Academy. Supported by the Academy Head Coach Joe, a Level 2 USA Hockey and Team Coach of our U13 League Team, along with Ivan our Learn to Play and Jonny our Learn to Skate Head Coaches.

We are managed by a committee which is elected by club members (or their parents/guardians). All parents can stand for election to the committee when vacancies are available.

All queries should be directed to info.norstarhockey@gmail.com or ask to speak to the coaches after training. If you have a welfare or safeguarding concern, Wendy the Club Secretary and Anka our Child Protection Officer are available to consult and guide you. We also have two parents' representatives who sit on the Committee Karen and Renata. Copies of our Club policies are available upon request.

What do I need?

If you already have inline skates (and any protective gear) or inline/ice hockey equipment, then please bring it with you. Otherwise just come along in trainers. Bring a bicycle (or skateboard) helmet, if you have one. Also don't forget a (named) water bottle as training is thirsty work! These should be left on the table outside the hall door.

Inline hockey players wear inline skates, inline/ice hockey (helmets, elbow pads, shin guards and gloves), inline hockey shorts and use inline hockey sticks; older boys wear groin guards.

Inline hockey goalies wear goalie equipment (pads, blocker, catcher, helmet, body armour, shorts, inline skates, groin guard) and use a goalie stick.

We have a small stock of equipment which we will lend to club members, and we will also help members to source their own equipment (either new or second hand). The Club has a small stock of sticks available for purchase at a very discounted price.

Joining the club

Please complete a Club Membership form for your child (or children) and return to the Club Secretary. You will also need to pay the Annual Club membership fee (£15) and your first month's fees (see below). Club members must also register with Inline Hockey Ireland (IHI) to be allowed to participate in training.

Fees

The club annual membership fee is £15 per player. There is also a monthly fee of £25 (which includes all game fees). We offer discounted rates for siblings or children living in the same household (£15) per additional child; with a maximum monthly fee of £40 (per household).

All new members may try one week free of charge and then must join the club and monthly fees are due. If a member joins after the 15th of the month, their first month's fees are half price; otherwise the full month's fee is due.

Fees are due on the first of every month (excluding July & August) irrespective of attendance as detailed below.

If a club member is going to be absent from training for an extended period (one month or more), their parent/guardian may request a waiver of fees. A minimum of two week's notice should be given where possible.

Fees should be paid by standing order or bank transfer on the 1st of each month into the club business account (Sort Code: 090129, Account Number: 77643889, Name: Norstar Junior Inline Hockey Club). Please include your child's name(s) as the reference. Where electronic payment cannot be made, fees may be paid by cash, but a receipt must be obtained so that we have oversight and you have evidence of payment.

Fees must be paid promptly. If a club member appears for training with unpaid fees, they may not be allowed to train. If the club member is allowed to train, all outstanding fees must be paid (or an arrangement in place) before any further training. Guidance will be supplied on this going forward.

IHI Registration

Members transferring from Learn to Skate have already been enrolled with Inline hockey Ireland.

All other club members need to register as 'Learn to Play 2024-25 members or Under 18 Junior aged player (you will be advised which is applicable to your child) with Inline Hockey Ireland: <https://ihi.rsportz.com/memberships>

Club Communication

We use WhatsApp to communicate with parents/guardians of club members. We also post information on our public Facebook page. We would encourage you to like and follow us on Facebook: search for 'Ballymena Norstar Inline Hockey Club'. We also have a presence on Google search engines.

Injuries and Concussion

All parents are advised to read the 'Recognise and Remove' leaflet on concussion.

<https://www.education-ni.gov.uk/sites/default/files/publications/de/concussion-recognise-and-remove-leaflet.pdf>

The club implements the Graduated Return to Play (GRT) approach to concussion.

<https://keepyourbootson.co.uk/wp-content/uploads/2019/04/U19-Concussion-Management-Guidelines-2018.pdf>

Club Policies

All club policies are available on request. We can make these available electronically or in hard copy. These include the Club Constitution, Health and Safety Statement and Child Protection Policy. The Club has obtained Club Silvermark Status from Inline Hockey Ireland.

Wendy Muir (Club Secretary)

Email: info.norstarhockey@gmail.com

Message from the Chairman

We wish you a warm welcome to Norstar Hockey and look forward to the adventures and memories that you will create as we head off on this exciting journey. I and all the Club Committee are available and please reach out to us at any time.

Club Sponsorship is available, and we would welcome any support to allow us to grow, expand and promote this great club and sport.



Yours In Hockey

Scott Muir Club Chairman